FOOD & DRINK

TREND



Petite **Indulgence**

A hidden door, few stools, a small menu, quiet conversations; intimate bars are the new PDRs for watering holes.

Gagan Sharma

While there's something truly elegant about enjoying a well-crafted cocktail, India's traditional large-format cocktail bars can seldom claim the right environs for it—relaxed, intimate, and unrushed. That's why, cocktail bars are pivoting, and creating small, almost-secret sections within their space, or a reserved time-bound seating, that caters to precisely this ask.

The idea is simple. You can't find these bars, you learn about them through someone, a post on the Gram, or earn your rights through good behaviour, cultivated tastes, or being a regular at another deserving place. Then, make a reservation, usually for a 90-120 minutes lot, wait a few weeks, months maybe, and show-up. And when you finally do, surrender yourself to the hospitality, and live through your senses. These spaces know how to enamour you with sensible personalisation, elevated conversations, new elements, exhibitionist showman-ship and theatrics; leaving you with an experience to reminisce about fondly, if not longingly.